

- b. Malware:** Malware is software designed to engage in malicious behaviour on a device. They can perform actions like sending text messages to your contact list without your knowledge or give the attacker complete control over your phone. They're also used to steal personal and financial data which can be used for identity theft or financial fraud. In the last year, threats due to malware increased from 34 per cent to 48 per cent.
- c. Vulnerable applications:** Sometimes a developer isn't careful while designing his app and there might be certain loopholes in the app which can be exploited for malicious purposes. They can often allow an attacker to access sensitive information, perform undesirable actions, stop a service from functioning correctly, automatically download additional apps or otherwise engage in undesirable behaviour. If an app is transmitting data over an unencrypted Wi-Fi network using HTTP (rather than [HTTPS](#)), the data can be easily sniffed using freely-available software. Vulnerable apps are typically fixed by an update from the developer.
- d. Privacy threats:** Some applications gather more sensitive information than required to function posing a threat to your private information. A gaming application which looks into your contacts and your email is a fine example of this. Although not malicious, they're a cause for concern.

2. Web-based threats:

- a. Phishing scams:** These scams are designed to dupe ignorant internet users and get login information. Everyone reading this has got at least one mail asking them for their username and password probably in exchange for continuing to be able to use Facebook/Gmail which "is shutting down all fake accounts". There are phishing sites (fake web sites) designed to look like a bank's web site and trick users into giving their login information. Most of you might not have fallen into this trap but as per statistics, approximately 1 in 20 users will click on a phishing link every year on Android devices. Always remember that a legitimate web service will never ask you mail your password. Also, always check the URL of the web site before logging in.
- b. Drive-by downloads:** These are downloads that happen without your knowledge. They automatically begin downloading an app when you visit a web page.